ARENA SCHOOL
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ACAMIS TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE · OCTOBER 18, 2026

A case study from the INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校

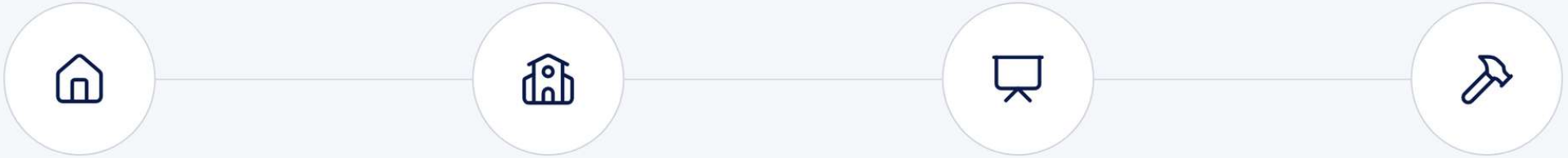
From Lab *to Classroom*

Running an AI Student Program



Presenting at demo day, Beijing 2026

From what families ask *to what teachers need.*



PART 1

What families ask

The ISB parent talk, what employers now want, and what parents ask us

PART 2

How we teach

Our philosophy, learning framework, outcomes, and assessment

PART 3

The proof

The ISB AI Founders week, from day one to demo day

PART 4

For teachers

The ethics, the comfort to build, and a short demo

AI tools change every week.
We teach learners to make the calls.

MEMBER OF ANTHROP\C *Startup Program* · OpenAI *Partner Network*

WHAT WE DO

Hands-on programs where every learner makes real things with AI.

HOW WE TEACH

- Learners make every decision
- AI does the building
- *Real work for a real audience*

WHO WE WORK WITH

- Students, grades 6 to 12
- Teachers and schools
- Parents and families

OUR TEAM STUDIED AT — INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

OUR TEAM WORKED AT — McKinsey&Company · Goldman Sachs · Y · Apple · Microsoft AI · Deloitte. · KIMI

PART 1

Families are asking what AI means *for their children's future.*

1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

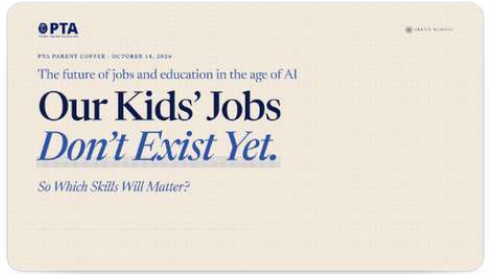
3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

A team takes the podium on demo day, Beijing 2026

ARENA SCHOOL

This week, we told ISB parents what is changing at work, *and what their children should practice now.*



THE TALK

Our kids' jobs don't exist yet. So which skills will matter?



WORK IS CHANGING

Jobs that require AI skills already pay 62% more.



STUDENTS FEEL IT

In China, 91% of graduating students changed plans; 57% are learning AI skills.



WHAT LASTS

Three human skills: agency, taste, and craft.

PwC 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer. China Youth Daily survey of 1,333 graduating students, May 2026.

Companies now want people who use AI *across the whole job, not only in technical roles.*



AI fluency

Uses AI on everyday work, in any role, not only engineering.



Works with agents

Hands multi-step work to AI agents, then checks what comes back.



Range

Learns new tools fast and works across the whole job.

Parents hear this at their own workplaces. *So they ask whether their children are learning it.*

WHAT FAMILIES ASK US

Parents are asking one practical question: *which skills will outlast the tools?*

From surveying parents in the ISB community and other local communities in mainland China

WHAT PARENTS CARE ABOUT

Which skills last as the tools change?

Will AI do the thinking for my child?

What should my child practice now?

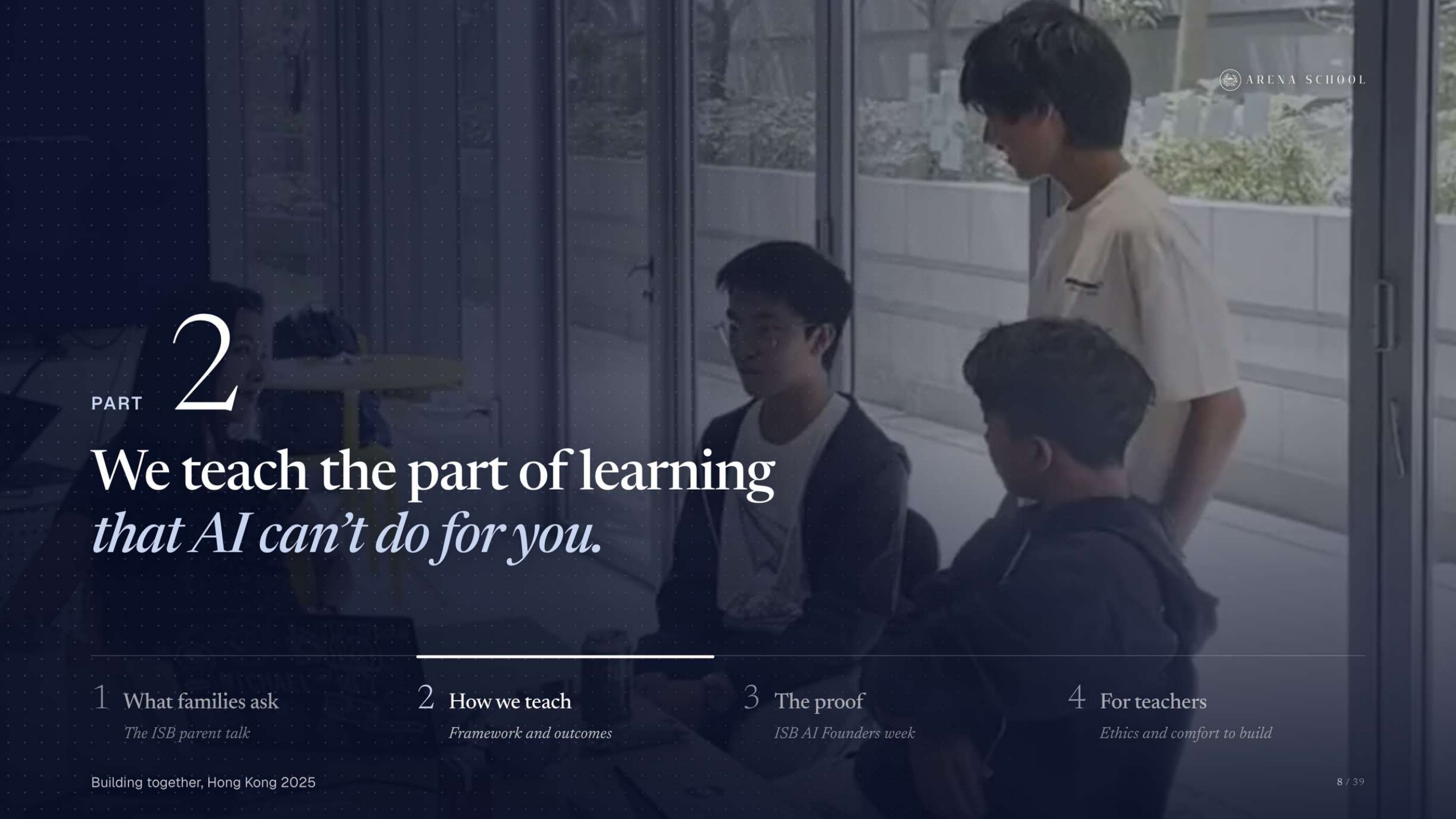
OUR ANSWER

Three skills outlast any tool

Used well, AI deepens thinking

Real products, in five days

Parents don't see AI as an academic subject, like learning to code.
They see it as a life skill: optional for many jobs today, and likely non-negotiable by the time their children start working.



PART 2

We teach the part of learning *that AI can't do for you.*

1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

THE QUESTION WE TRY TO ANSWER AT ARENA SCHOOL

When AI can do all of these in seconds, what must our students *still learn to do?*

Three human skills AI can't supply.
Without them, AI does the thinking.



01 · CHOOSE

Agency

Choosing what is worth doing, before anyone assigns it.

WITHOUT IT

AI picks the problem, and learners follow.



02 · JUDGE

Taste

Judging whether the output is actually good.

WITHOUT IT

Learners accept the first answer AI gives.



03 · FINISH

Craft

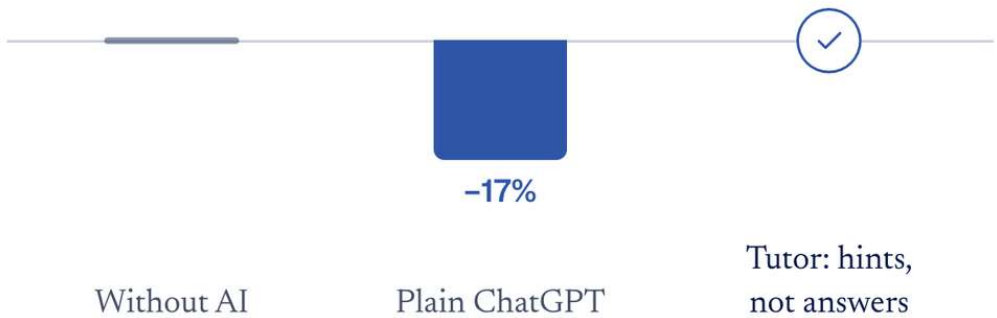
Finishing the work so people can trust it.

WITHOUT IT

The work stays an unchecked first draft.

Both used AI, *but the design determined the results.*

HIGH SCHOOL MATH · NEARLY 1,000 STUDENTS



–17% exam grades after practicing with plain ChatGPT. The tutor version largely avoided the drop.

HARVARD PHYSICS · A RANDOMIZED TRIAL



2× the learning gains of an active-learning class, in less time, with an AI tutor built on the same methods

Bastani and others, PNAS, June 25, 2025: grades fell 17% once plain ChatGPT was taken away; with safeguards, the harm was “largely mitigated”; Kestin and others, Scientific Reports, June 3, 2025: 194 Harvard physics students, median learning gains more than double

AI helps at every step of the cycle.
Every decision stays with the learner.

01 Inquiry and planning

Which problem, for whom, and the plan

Suggests angles and drafts the plan

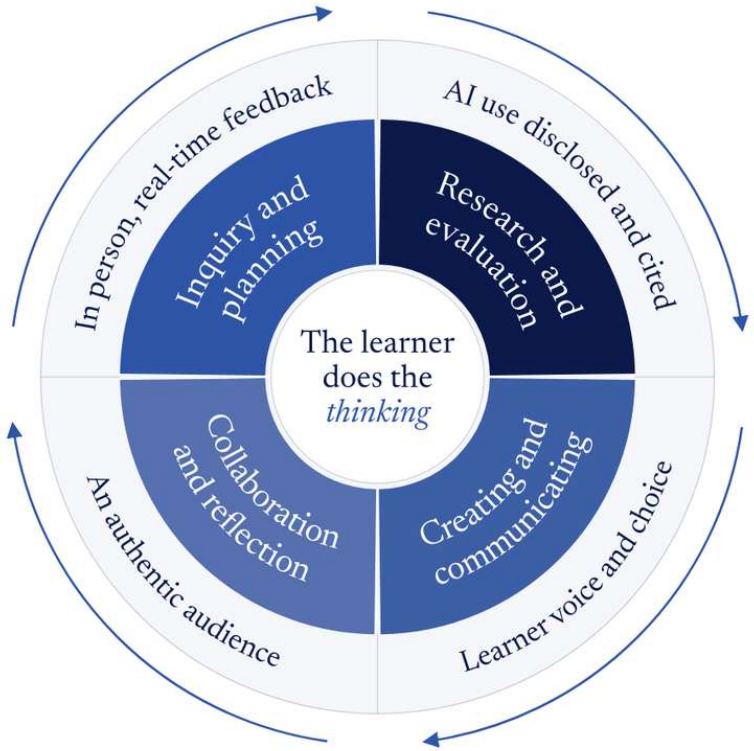
"Why this problem?"

04 Collaboration and reflection

What to change after critique

Gives a first round of feedback

"What would you do differently?"



02 Research and evaluation

Which sources and answers to trust

Searches, summarizes, and compares options

"How did you check it?"

03 Creating and communicating

What to build, and what to cut

Writes the code, drafts, and visuals

"How do you know it's good?"

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Across every program, *learners will be able to...*

Learners are whoever a program is for: students, teachers, school leaders, or parents. The outcomes stay the same; the depth grows.

Inquiry and planning	• Turn a broad interest into a focused, researchable question. • Plan a project with milestones, and adjust the plan based on progress.
Research and evaluation	• Find, evaluate, and cite sources, including checking the accuracy of AI output. • Compare options against criteria, and justify a choice. • Explain how AI tools work, where they fail, and the bias and privacy issues they raise.
Creating and communicating	• Build and test a product, prototype, or solution, deciding which steps to hand to AI and disclosing how they used it. • Structure an argument and write it clearly, in their own words. • Present to an authentic audience, and defend their reasoning under questioning.
Collaboration and reflection	• Work in a team, share roles, and contribute to a shared product. • Give and use critique from teachers and peers to revise their work. • Reflect on their process and on what they would do differently.

When AI can polish the product, *we assess the thinking behind it.*

THE PRODUCT

What AI can polish

THE THINKING BEHIND IT *What we assess*

IN PRACTICE *Used with ISB students, summer 2026*

Inquiry and planning

Turn a broad interest into a focused, researchable question.

Research and evaluation

Find, evaluate, and cite sources, including checking the accuracy of AI output.

Creating and communicating

Build and test a product, deciding which steps to hand to AI and disclosing how they used it.

Collaboration and reflection

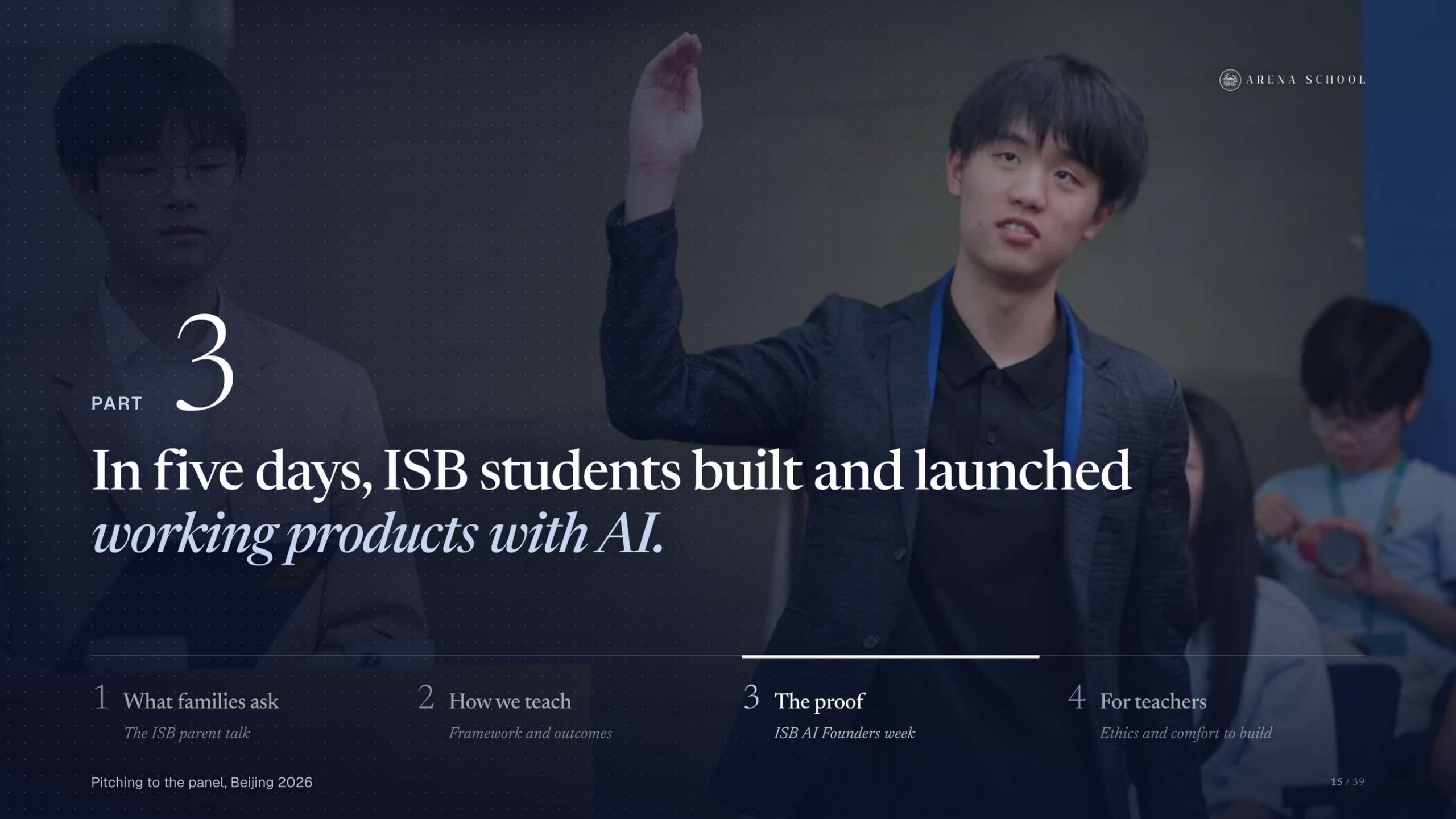
Give and use critique from teachers and peers to revise their work.

EVIDENCE WE ASSESS

Process journal

Drafts

Recorded defense



PART 3

In five days, ISB students built and launched *working products with AI.*

1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

Pitching to the panel, Beijing 2026

An AI builder week for grades 7 to 12:
learn AI skills, start a company, build something real.



Mentors in the room every day



Every team demos what works

7–12 grades, selected by application

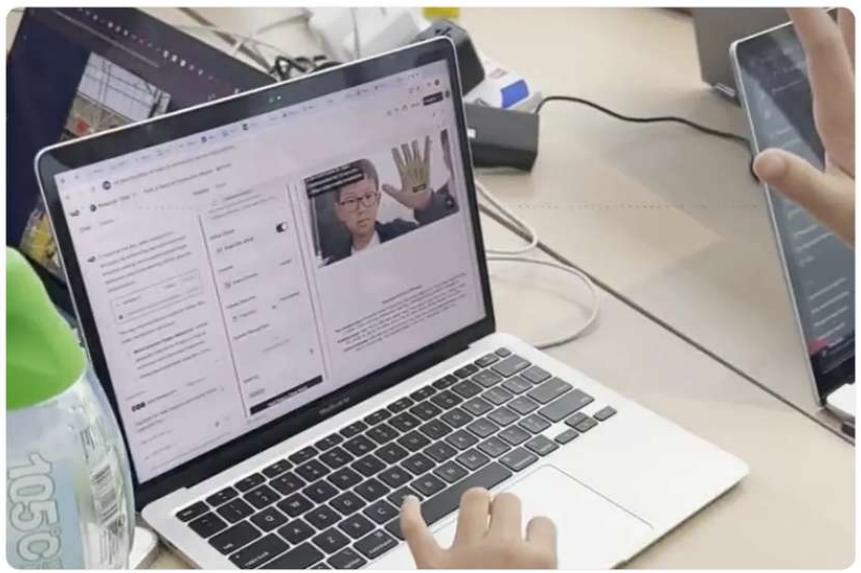
5 days, at ISB in August

0 coding experience required

Ten stages in five days, *and every day ends with something real.*

	DAY 1 Pick a problem	DAY 2 Go public	DAY 3 The rebuild	DAY 4 Polish and price	DAY 5 Demo day
STAGES	*01* Find the idea *02* Validate it *03* Form the team *04* Define it	*05* Design it *06* Build it *07* Ship it live	*08* Test and iterate	*09* Brand it	*10* Pitch and sell
MAIN TOOLS					
SKILL TRAINED	AGENCY	TASTE	TASTE	CRAFT	CRAFT
OUTPUT	*A one-page plan and a first prototype*	*A live link that real people try*	*A rebuilt product, shaped by users*	*A name, a landing page, and a price*	*A two-minute pitch to judges and families*

In five days, an 11-year-old *turned sign language into speech.*



Built in five days by a seventh grader

01 Found the problem AGENCY

His cousin is deaf. Nobody assigned it.

02 Sketched it AGENCY

Sign language in, spoken words out.

03 Built it CRAFT

AI tools did the building. He made every call.

04 Changed it TASTE

His grandmother couldn't use version one, so he fixed the audio.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- *Turn an interest into a focused question*
- *Build and test a product*
- *Use critique to revise the work*

On day five, teams pitched working products *to judges from Harvard, Stanford, Y Combinator, and AI labs.*



Judges test each product before scoring



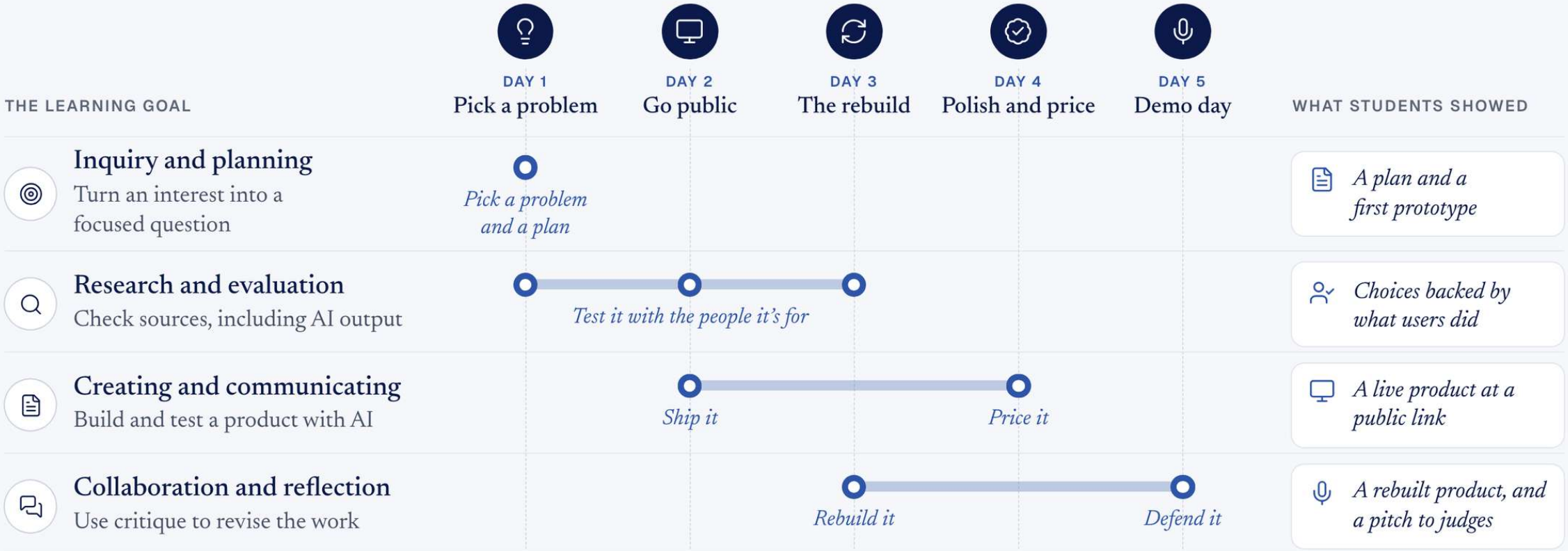
Every team pitched its own product



Teams defended their choices live

JUDGED BY FOUNDERS AND OPERATORS FROM HARVARD Stanford Y Combinator *and AI labs*

Every learning goal, practiced on real work *for real people, in five days.*



No worksheet or quiz, because we were part of the build process, in person. *The evidence is in their pitch and defense.*

PART 4

Families care about AI, *so teachers need to know it too.*

1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

Walking the panel through a working build, Beijing 2026

Teachers need two things: *the ethics, and the comfort to build.*

Ethics and responsible use

- When AI use is fair, and how students disclose and cite it
- What never goes into an AI tool: student names and data
- How to assess the process, not only the polished product

Comfort to build

- Has built one small thing with AI, start to finish
- Knows the steps students take: prompt, test, and fix
- Can ask any student, “How did you check it?”

Students are already using these tools. *The adults guiding them need to know what that looks like.*

You don’t need to be a master vibe coder.
You need to know what your students are doing.

Vibe coding: building software by describing it to AI in plain English

YOU DON’T NEED TO

- Build launch-ready apps
- Keep up with every new tool
- Write code

YOU DO NEED TO

- Build one small tool for your class
- Know the steps students take
- Ask about the process behind their work

Comfortable means you can follow how a student reached the outcome they present.
That’s what lets you coach it, and assess it.

Teachers don't need to code *to build for their own class.*

ENGLISH · FROM A TEACHER WE SPOKE WITH

Literary devices, one click away

SONNET 18 · LINES 5–7

METAPHOR

Sometime too hot the eye of heaven shines,

PERSONIFICATION

And often is his gold complexion dimm'd;

ALLITERATION

And every fair from fair sometime declines,

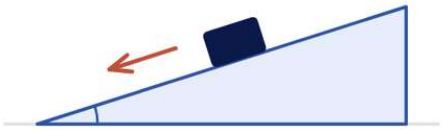
Instead of color-coding a poem by hand at the board, the teacher tags each literary device before class.

In class, one click reveals each device and its label.

Class time goes to discussing the poem.

SCIENCE · WHAT A STEM TEACHER CAN BUILD

A simulation made for this class



Angle **20°**

Friction **0.3**

Students take a model apart and rebuild it, or change one variable in a physics setup.

Built for this lesson, not the nearest YouTube demo.

Students test ideas instead of watching one.

Here's what comfortable looks like: *one sentence, one working tool.*

STEP 1 · YOU SAY IT — AGENCY

One plain sentence

A change to a classroom tool, called out by the room.

"Add a Chinese version of the parent email."

"Add a timer to the quiz."

→

STEP 2 · AI BUILDS IT — CRAFT

Claude Code writes it

An AI tool that builds web apps from plain English.

Claude Code *by Anthropic*

```
› Add a Chinese version of the parent email under the English one.
```

→ *Working in about two minutes*

→

STEP 3 · WE CHECK IT — TASTE

Try it on the big screen

Then ask what we ask students: how did you check it?

"Does the Chinese match the English?"

"Does it change with the tone?"

Your role becomes the coach, *and three questions do the coaching.*

THE TEACHER'S ROLE

From the person with the answers

↓

to the coach who asks the questions

It's what good teachers already do, and what our mentors did all week.

01
AGENCY

"Why this problem?"

They choose, not the AI.

02
TASTE

"How do you know it's good?"

They judge what it made.

03
CRAFT

"What would make someone trust it?"

They check it and finish it.

AI can do the making.
The thinking is still ours to teach.



1

Families care

Parents see AI as a life skill, and they ask what children practice.

2

Design decides

Same AI, opposite results. Learners choose, judge, and finish.

3

Students can ship

Live products in five days, with no coding background.

4

Teachers need both

The ethics, and enough comfort to build one small tool.

For teachers, you don't need to be a master "vibe coder." You just need to know what your students are doing, so you can keep coaching them.

THANK YOU · QUESTIONS WELCOME

Let's build this at your school.
We'd love to work with you.

WHAT WE RUN · *three pillars, one framework, planned with your team and run on your campus*

STUDENTS

Build and pitch a real product with AI

Entrepreneurship & AI Intensive
App Design Workshop
College Portfolio Workshop

SCHOOLS AND TECH TEAMS

AI training that works inside your school's rules

AI for Educators
Tech coaches and IT directors

FAMILIES AND COMMUNITY

Honest talks on AI, work, and college

Community Dialogues
Parent coffees and talks

KEEP IN TOUCH · *scan for today's materials, or reach us directly*

Today's slides, checklist, and tool guide

SCAN WITH YOUR PHONE

CONTACT

WECHAT
jj-xiaohan

EMAIL
contact@arenaschool.org

WEBSITE
arenaschool.org

MEMBER OF ANTHROP\C *Startup Program* OpenAI *Partner Network*

Students learned 20+ AI tools in five days, *out of 200+ they could choose from.*

200+ AI TOOLS STUDENTS COULD CHOOSE FROM · 20+ THEY USED

RESEARCH
Ask and search

- ChatGPT
- Gemini
- NotebookLM
- Manus
- Mistral
- Claude
- Perplexity
- DeepSeek
- Grok

DESIGN
Logos and art

- Midjourney
- Ideogram
- Krea
- Recraft

BUILD
Apps and sites

- Cursor
- Lovable
- Replit
- v0
- Windsurf

BRAND
Sound and video

- Suno
- ElevenLabs
- CapCut

LAUNCH
Sell and promote

- Stripe
- Pika
- Runway

Teachers don't lack ideas. *They lack time, approved tools, and a place to start.*

"We have no time for more PD."

- Start from one task you already do, and make the tool in the session.

"I'm not technical. Will I keep up?"

- No coding: you describe the tool in plain English.

"What about students using AI to cheat?"

- Assess the process: drafts, reflections, and the reasons behind each change.

"Our school restricts tools and student data."

- Use only the tools your school approves, with no student data in them.

AI gives teachers back time *to spend on their students.*

31% less time on lesson planning with AI in a randomized trial, with no drop in quality



5.9 hours saved a week by teachers who use AI weekly, about six weeks a school year

FROM A TEACHER WE SPOKE WITH

A grading timer, *not a grader*

Paper 9 of 24 — 4:12 / 6:00

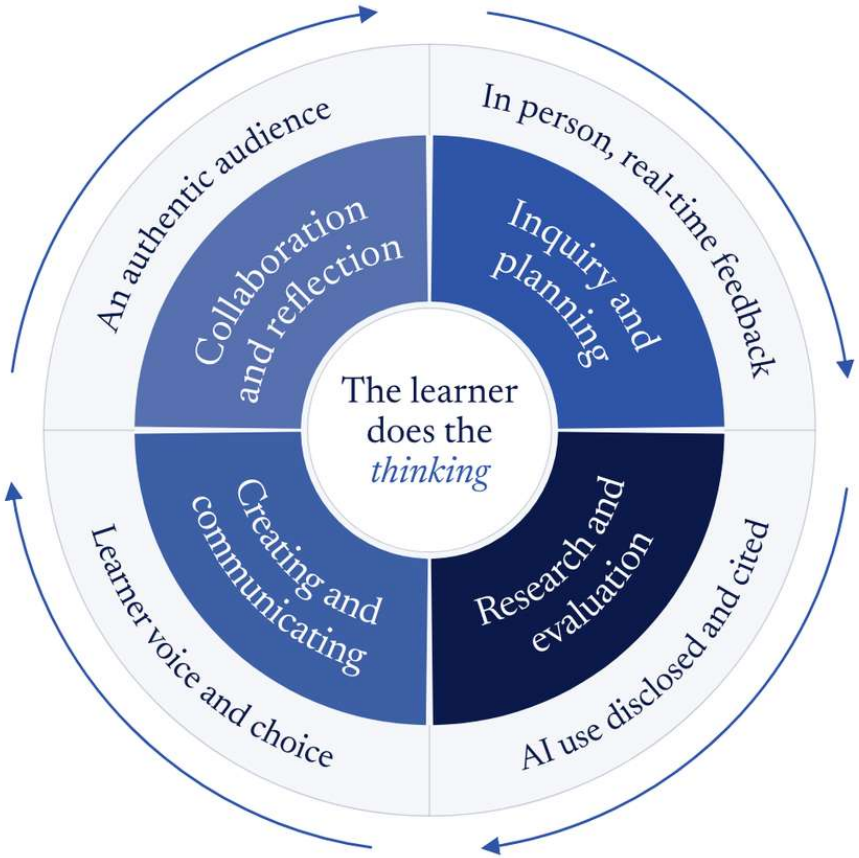
An English teacher built a simple timer. It grades nothing: he still reads every paper and writes the feedback himself.

It gives every paper the same share of his time, and keeps his marking within a set limit.

AI handles the housekeeping. *The teacher keeps the judgment.*

EEF/NFER, randomized trial, 259 teachers in 68 schools (2024). Gallup and Walton Family Foundation (2025): weekly AI users, n=2,232, self-reported estimate.

Learners do the thinking, AI is a tool, *and teachers and peers give the feedback.*



BUILT ON PROJECT-BASED LEARNING

Every strand gets a real purpose and a real audience.
AI speeds up the building.

Informed by PBLWorks' Gold Standard PBL.

AT EVERY CHECK-IN, THE TEACHER ASKS

"How did you check it?"

and responds in real time.
AI can support that feedback, not replace it.

BACKUP · THE ASSESSMENT RUBRIC

We assess the process, *not only the product.*

SAMPLE CRITERION · RESEARCH AND EVALUATION

Evaluates sources, including AI output

BEGINNING
Accepts sources and AI output as given; cites inconsistently.

DEVELOPING
Checks some claims against a second source; cites most sources.

PROFICIENT
Verifies key claims, including AI output, against reliable sources; discloses AI use.

EXTENDING
Explains why sources disagree, corrects AI errors, and judges which evidence to trust.

EVIDENCE WE COLLECT

Process journal · Drafts · Recorded defense

IN PRACTICE
Used with students in the ISB AI Founders Program, summer 2026.

BACKUP · ONE FRAMEWORK, THREE KINDS OF PROGRAM

The same framework runs every program.
The learner and the output change.

	STUDENT SHORT COURSE AI Founders week	TEACHER TRAINING AI for Educators	CURRICULUM DESIGN AI in your courses
01 INQUIRY AND PLANNING	Choose a problem and pitch it in three minutes	Pick one task from a class you teach	Map where AI fits in each course
02 RESEARCH AND EVALUATION	Talk to the people they want to help	Check every result the tool gives	Decide when AI doesn't belong
03 CREATING AND COMMUNICATING	Build a live product at a public link	Make the tool on your approved tools	Write rubrics that assess the process
04 COLLABORATION AND REFLECTION	Defend every decision on demo day	Share the tool and the prompt behind it	Collect drafts, reflections, and reasons
LEARNERS LEAVE WITH	A live product and a pitch	A tool for their own class	A plan and rubrics the faculty owns

BACKUP · LOOKING BACK ON THE WEEK

The ISB week gave each skill *a moment students couldn't skip.*

01 Agency

Choosing what is worth doing, before anyone assigns it.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

On day one, each student chooses the problem and pitches it in three minutes, with no slides.

02 Taste

Judging whether the output is actually good.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

By midweek, a prototype is online at a public link, and real users and mentors react every day.

03 Craft

Finishing the work so people can trust it.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

Building stops at a fixed hour each day, and on demo day students explain every decision live.

BACKUP · WHERE AI HELPS

Used well, AI gives every learner *more time for the thinking.*

FOR STUDENTS

AI does the making

So their time goes to choosing, judging, and finishing.

OUTCOME

Build and test a product with AI

FOR TEACHERS

AI takes the chores

So time goes to feedback, in person and in real time.

OUTCOME

Give and use critique to revise the work

FOR SCHOOLS

One framework for all

One rubric across students, teachers, and courses.

OUTCOME

Evaluate sources, including AI output

BACKUP · THE FOUNDERS OF ARENA SCHOOL

We build programs from inside schools, *and from inside the AI industry.*



Phillip An

CO-FOUNDER

Computer science at Caltech; MBA and master's in engineering at Harvard. McKinsey and Goldman Sachs.

Co-founded Homebase, the first company from Vietnam backed by Y Combinator. Forbes 30 Under 30; Schwarzman Scholar.

phillip@arenaschool.org



Jing Jing Yang

CO-FOUNDER

Grew up at WAB and ISB. Economics and behavioral decision sciences at Brown; Schwarzman Scholar at Tsinghua.

Research with Microsoft AI; worked at Apple, Deloitte, and Kimi (Moonshot AI).

jingjing@arenaschool.org

BACKUP · IS USING AI JUST CHEATING?

No. AI tools write the code, *and students make every decision.*

AI TOOLS AND MENTORS HANDLE

Writing the code

Putting it online

Fixing technical errors

STUDENTS DECIDE

Which problem, and for whom

What to cut after users try it

The name, the price, and the pitch

BACKUP · PLANNING CHECKLIST

Your school already owns most of this.
Arena School can help with the rest.

YOUR SCHOOL OWNS

The learning goals and lasting skills

A five-day block on the calendar

Teachers, IT, and families on board

How students show their work

WHERE ARENA SCHOOL HELPS

Matching AI tools to each task

Prompting that builds thinking

Tools that work on your network

An idea to a product in five days

Checklist and China tool guide: arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

How we teach: arenaschool.org/approach